

Global Luxury Goods

Global Luxury Goods: The accelerating loop of Story-Social-Shop



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We have written before how TV role models impact the lifestyles and aspirations of entire generations in [China](#), but also the [West](#). Keeping with the [exploding complexity](#) principle, luxury brands need to move at the speed of culture in order to stay relevant. Streaming releases, social feeds and shoppable platforms have compressed the old cycle of editorials-runway-retail into a rapid loop of story-social-shop.

First, a series or film launches a distinctive aesthetic that gives consumers a fully formed visual narrative anchored in story and emotion, rather than just a product. Love Story (based on the tragic romance of JFK Jr and Carolyn Bessette-Kennedy) crystallises 90s minimalism; Wuthering Heights (starring Margot Robbie and Jacob Elordi) delivers a Gothic Romance wardrobe set against windswept moors. The characters' style becomes a proxy for a mood and identity consumers can buy into. Press tours now extend and pre-sell that aesthetic before the film or series even lands. Margot Robbie's method dressing around the Barbie press tour set the template in delivering sartorial hysteria; she repeated the playbook for Wuthering Heights, moving the trend straight off the set and onto the street. The result was an immediate spike in desire for period dressing and, specifically, Vivienne Westwood's corset dress, which saw demand on Lyst rise 88% quarter-on-quarter.

Second, as soon as the series or movie premieres, brands move to formalise the trend, guided by data-driven merchandising and real-time search behaviour. Less than a week after Love Story launched, Polo Ralph Lauren (not covered) posted a campaign on social media clearly inspired by the protagonist and his aesthetic. A week later, Uniqlo (not covered) followed with its own interpretation, while Starbucks (covered by the U.S. restaurants team) joined in with a tongue-in-cheek Instagram reference to JFK Jr. For some brands, the upside is outsized. Calvin Klein (not covered) was served cultural relevance on a silver platter with Love Story: CBK was a CK publicist and the brand features heavily in the show, despite its lack of official involvement. Lyst searches for Calvin Klein went up +43%, while its website traffic increased 41% MoM after the series launched. On PVH's annual earnings call, the CEO noted, "We can't talk about CK today without referencing Love Story, the TV show." The stock rose 9.75% after results, helped by the show's virality. So far, this looks largely like a US-centric phenomenon with some spillover into other Western markets and limited adoption in Asia.

Third, the trend goes mainstream. E-commerce makes the inspiration-to-purchase journey almost frictionless: consumers can move from seeing a look on screen or social to "their" version in a few taps. Algorithms reward repetition and recognisability, so early adopters and influencers quickly translate the cinematic wardrobe into real-life outfits and "get the look" content, turning fantasy into something anyone can recreate at home. Official license partners (often [high street retailers](#)) drop limited-edition collaborations to ride the wave. The H&M x Wuthering Heights 11-piece capsule is a case in point, designed to capture the media frenzy and drive traffic in store and online. These drops generate more content which help extend the trend's lifespan. By that point, early adopters have usually moved on to the next micro-phenomenon, following the [piracy paradox](#).

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			18 May	TTM		Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
			Closing	Price	Rel.							
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price	Target	Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
BIRK (Birkenstock)	M	USD	32.12	50.00	(66.0)%	EUR	1.85	2.01	2.49	14.9	13.7	11.1
BC.IM (Brunello Cucinelli)	O	EUR	82.10	108.00	(34.9)%	EUR	1.99	2.26	2.65	41.3	36.3	31.0
BRBY.LN (Burberry)	O	GBP	1,083.00	1,300.00	(1.4)%	GBP	0.24	0.39		44.3	27.9	19.7
CFR.SW (Richemont)	O	CHF	154.65	200.00	(15.5)%	EUR	6.39	6.12	6.87	26.4	27.6	24.6
ZGN	O	USD	12.69	14.00	38.2%	EUR	0.45	0.42	0.60	24.3	26.0	18.2
EL.FP (EssilorLuxottica)	M	EUR	174.20	185.00	(42.5)%	EUR	6.79	7.65	8.95	25.6	22.8	19.5
RMS.FP (Hermes)	O	EUR	1,580.00	2,150.00	(47.5)%	EUR	43.12	44.33	52.47	36.6	35.6	30.1
KER.FP (Kering)	M	EUR	239.50	220.00	27.5%	EUR	4.35	6.66	10.04	55.1	36.0	23.9
MC.FP (LVMH)	O	EUR	456.25	600.00	(17.1)%	EUR	22.73	22.22	26.71	20.1	20.5	17.1
MONC.IM (Moncler)	M	EUR	49.25	57.50	(21.4)%	EUR	2.31	2.44	2.64	21.3	20.2	18.7
1913.HK (Prada SpA)	O	HKD	35.56	50.00	(70.3)%	EUR	0.33	0.32	0.36	11.7	12.4	11.0
SFER.IM (Ferragamo)	O	EUR	6.94	8.80	8.5%	EUR	(0.30)	0.04	0.15	(23.5)	184.8	47.3
UHR.SW (Swatch)	O	CHF	201.90	180.00	27.1%	CHF	0.03	4.32	8.16	N/M	46.7	24.7
SPX			7,353.61									
EDME			1,514.18									
EMLSF			5,952.61									
ASIAx			1,894.75									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

BRBY.LN base year is 2026;

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

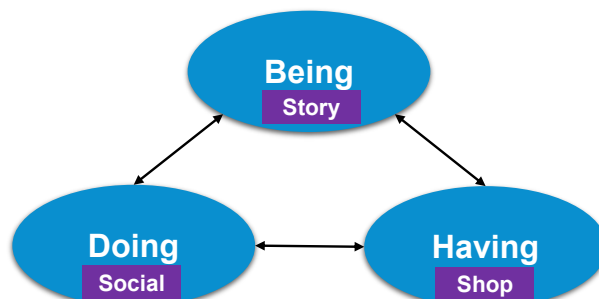
INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

The open question is whether brands can consistently turn these cultural spikes into sustainable revenue before the moment evaporates. PVH's CEO gave concrete examples of how Calvin Klein is trying to do just that: a 90s-heavy product assortment and marketing focus, which generated higher-than-average social engagement and click-through rates, and strategic styling of key talent. By contrast, Prada and Dior appear to have kept a more measured distance from the launch of [The Devil Wears Prada 2](#). Despite a short-lived uptick in Google searches and dressing key talent for red carpets, they have not leaned fully into the phenomenon. That hasn't deterred others: we count more than ten brands, from Grey Goose to United Airlines, that have jumped in with opportunistic campaigns. The underlying lesson is clear: brands can no longer rely on heritage or product alone. They need to exist inside a wider cultural ecosystem—where image, narrative and accessibility reinforce one another—or risk watching others harvest the trends that their own products helped inspire in the first place.

DETAILS

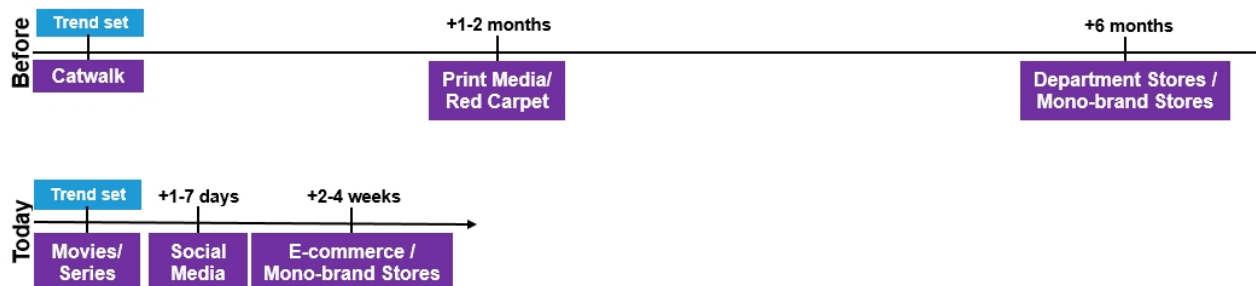
We have written before how TV role models impact the lifestyles and aspirations of entire generations in [China](#), but also the [West](#). Keeping with the [exploding complexity](#) principle, luxury brands need to move at the speed of culture in order to stay relevant. Streaming releases, social feeds and shoppable platforms have compressed the old cycle of editorials-runway-retail into a rapid loop of story-social-shop.

EXHIBIT 1: Luxury goods support people's identity through "having". This projective identification cycle is being compressed from the old cycle of editorials-runway-retail into a rapid loop of story-social-shop.



Source: Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 2: Streaming, social media and e-commerce have accelerated luxury trends: what used to take months before, now takes weeks.



Source: Bernstein analysis

First, a series or film launches a distinctive aesthetic that gives consumers a fully formed visual narrative anchored in story and emotion, rather than just a product. Love Story (based on the tragic romance of JFK Jr and Carolyn Bessette-Kennedy) crystallises 90s minimalism and polished Ivy League ease; Wuthering Heights (starring Margot Robbie and Jacob Elordi) delivers a Gothic Romance wardrobe set against windswept moors. The characters' style becomes a proxy for a mood and identity consumers can buy into. Press tours now extend and pre-sell that aesthetic before the film or series even lands. Margot Robbie's method dressing around the Barbie press tour set the template in delivering sartorial hysteria; she repeated the playbook for Wuthering Heights, moving the trend straight off the set and onto the street. The result was an immediate spike in demand for period dressing and, specifically, Vivienne Westwood's corset dress, which saw demand on Lyst rise 88% quarter-on-quarter.

EXHIBIT 3: **Margot Robbie's method dressing around the Barbie press tour set the template in delivering sartorial hysteria; she repeated the playbook for Wuthering Heights, moving the trend straight off the set and onto the street.**



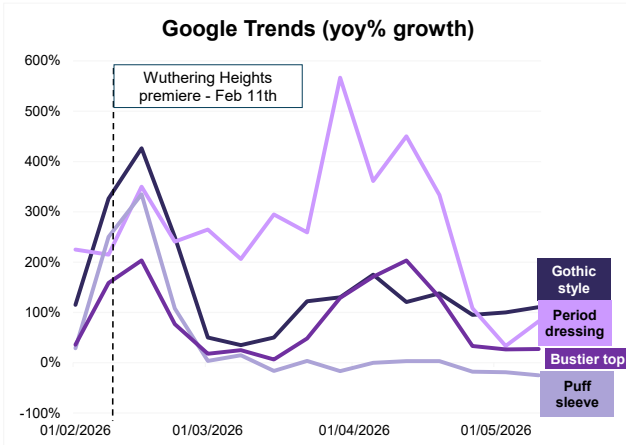
Source: Instagram, Company websites, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 4: **The FW26 trends were reinterpreted by editors through the lens of the cultural sensation that became the Wutherng Heights movie, with gothic, opulent and elegant at the forefront.**

The Fall/Winter 2026 Trends			
Net-a-Porter	Coveteur	Hypebeast	WhoWhatWear
Mood: Gothic romance	Long Exit (trains)	The Boiler Suit (Workwear)	Modern Heirlooms
Key colors: purple, green, ochre, red	Tactile Texture (fur, shearling, fringe)	Crimson (primary red)	Minimal, pure, essential
Key piece: the minimalist dress	Pin It (brooches)	Silver surfaces	Romantic and grandiose
Boots as pants	Dark Romance	Leopardmania	Fur
The styling trick: layers upon layers	Checked Out (plaid, tartan)	Asymmetrical Embellishments	Tuxedos
Haute hosiery	Statement Fur	Dirty & Disheveled (distressed textures)	Fitted looks
Folk tales	The New Suit (skirt suits)		
The texture: velvet	Open Season (open bags)		
The finishing touch: long gloves			

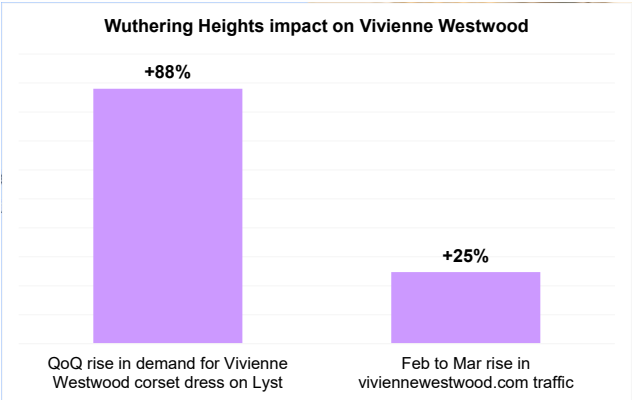
Source: Industry media, company websites, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 5: **The result was an immediate spike in demand for period dressing...**



Source: Google Trends, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 6: **...specifically, Vivienne Westwood's corset dress, which saw demand on Lyst rise 88% quarter-on-quarter.**



Source: Lyst, Semrush, Bernstein analysis

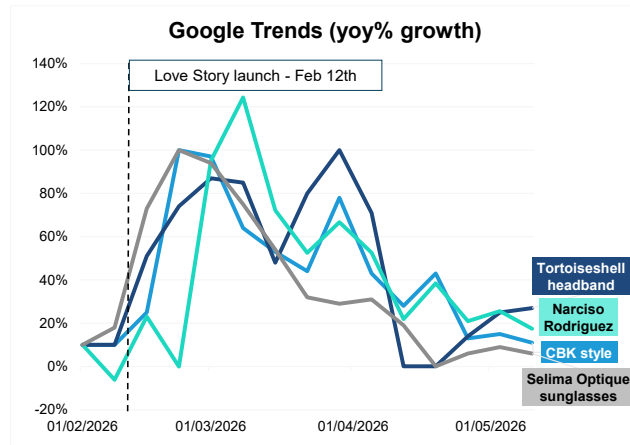
Second, as soon as the series or movie premieres, brands move to formalise the trend, guided by data-driven merchandising and real-time search behaviour. Less than a week after Love Story launched, Polo Ralph Lauren (not covered) posted a campaign on social media clearly inspired by the protagonist and his aesthetic. A week later, Uniqlo followed with its own interpretation, while Starbucks (covered by the U.S. restaurants team) joined in with a tongue-in-cheek Instagram reference to JFK Jr. For some brands, the upside is outsized. Calvin Klein (not covered) was served cultural relevance on a silver platter with Love Story: CBK was a CK publicist and the brand features heavily in the show, despite its lack of official involvement. Lyst searches for Calvin Klein went up +43%, while its website traffic increased 41% MoM after the series launched. On PVH's annual earnings call, the CEO noted, "We can't talk about CK today without referencing Love Story, the TV show." The stock rose 9.75% after results, helped by the show's virality. So far, this looks largely like a US-centric phenomenon with some spillover into other Western markets and limited adoption in Asia.

EXHIBIT 7: Less than a week after Love Story launched on February 12th, Polo Ralph Lauren posted a campaign on social media clearly inspired by the protagonist and his aesthetic. A week later, Uniqlo followed with its own interpretation, while Starbucks joined in with a tongue-in-cheek Instagram reference to JFK Jr.



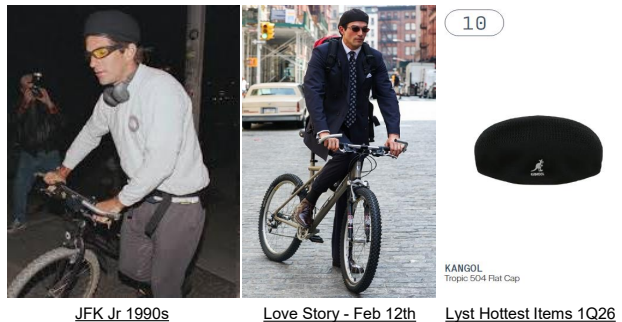
Ralph Lauren and Fast Retailing (Uniqlo) not covered. Starbucks covered by Danilo Gargiulo in the U.S. Restaurants team. Sporty and Rich private.
Source: Instagram, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 8: Highly specific items like CBK's headband or sunglasses are cutting through the noise, with CBK acting as a reference for customer shopping decisions.



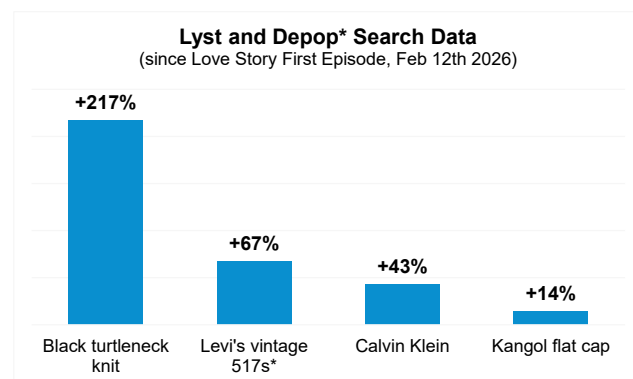
Source: Google Trends, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 9: The Kangol cap, worn by JFK Jr. and his namesake in the series was one of the top 10 most searched items on Lyst in 1Q26



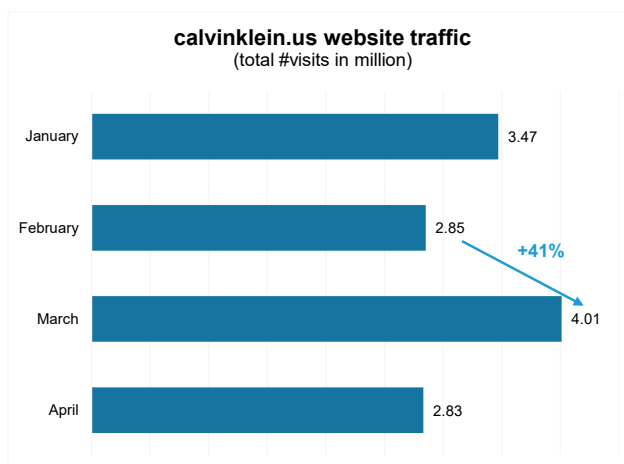
Source: Instagram, Lyst, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 10: Lyst searches for Love Story-inspired products shot up, with Calvin Klein the stand-out brand linked to the series.



Source: Lyst, Depop, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 11: Calvin Klein was served cultural relevance on a silver platter as the brand features heavily in the show. Its website traffic increased 41% MoM as a result.



Source: Semrush, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 12: On PVH's annual earnings call, the CEO noted, "We can't talk about CK today without referencing Love Story, the TV show." The stock rose 9.75% after results, helped by the show's virality and its sales momentum.

PVH Fiscal 4Q26 Earnings Call - April 1st 2026

Stefan Larsson, CEO: [We can't talk about Calvin Klein today without referencing Love Story, the TV show.](#) The cultural resonance of Love Story reinforces the timeless power of the Calvin Klein brand and its authentic place in American fashion with the premiere driving a surge in online interest in Calvin. [We're capitalizing on the Love Story effect in multiple ways](#) that are true to the brand, leveraging the 90s focus in our product assortment and marketing as supercharging it in e-commerce and stores with [a Spring 90s edit on calvinklein.com that is driving above-average social engagement and click-through rates.](#)

[We are also styling key talent](#), including actress Sarah Pidgeon, who plays Carolyn Bessette-Kennedy at the recent Vanity Fair Oscar Party. And we hosted a New York Magazine pop-up collaboration at our new SoHo store, achieving our highest daily sales and visitors to-date.

It's almost impossible to have a conversation about Calvin right now without Love Story. So could we anticipate it? I don't believe anyone could have anticipated the magnitude of the hit it has become globally and across generation. So if you look -- we just got the data yesterday that over 40 million people have watched Love Story at Hulu's most streamed show ever. So what's the learning for us and what's the effect?

[When the show launched, we could see the search increase for Calvin Klein, e-commerce traffic, D2C is positive. The consumer is looking for iconic Calvin starting with iconic underwear and iconic denim, the most sold denim style right now is the 90s fit.](#) So some of the key learnings here is you can plan for these things, but what I'm really excited about and is what the team has done over the past three, four years is, we have gone back to the DNA of what made Calvin polite with culture back in the 90s when that happened and really taken 100% of that iconic DNA and then working hard to make it 100% current... This is a good example of this because the interest we see spans generations and then, one of the biggest audience parts of Love Story is also where we have built the most strength which is within the young millennial and the Gen Z consumers.

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

Third, the trend goes mainstream. E-commerce makes the inspiration-to-purchase journey almost frictionless: consumers can move from seeing a look on screen or social to "their" version in a few taps. Algorithms reward repetition and recognisability, so early adopters and influencers quickly translate the cinematic wardrobe into real-life outfits, hauls and "get the look" content, turning fantasy into something anyone can recreate at home. Official license partners (often [high street retailers](#)) drop limited-edition collaborations to ride the wave. The H&M x Wuthering Heights 11-piece capsule is a case in point, designed to capture the media frenzy and drive traffic in store and online. These drops generate more content—OOTDs, styling reels, unboxings—which become new discovery for the next wave of consumers and help extend the trend's lifespan. By that point, early adopters have usually moved on to the next micro-phenomenon, following the [piracy paradox](#).

EXHIBIT 13: **The H&M x Wuthering Heights 11-piece capsule collection was designed to capture the media frenzy and drive traffic in store and online.**

H&M's 'Wuthering Heights' Collection Limited Edition drop launched February 9th				
\$19.99	\$19.99	\$24.99	\$24.99	\$24.99
\$44.99	\$44.99	\$44.99	\$59.99	\$59.99

Source: Company website, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 14: **Similarly, Aspal of London's limited edition collaboration helped them ride the publicity wave of the movie, right in time for Valentine's Day.**

Aspal of London 'Wuthering Heights' Collection Limited Edition drop launched February 4th				
\$185	\$125	\$125	\$165	\$165
\$135	\$300	\$115	\$115	

Source: Company website, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 15: **Bloomingdale's 59th St in New York took it one step further, with a month-long Wuthering Heights-inspired window display, a curated pop up on the ground floor and activation events around it.**



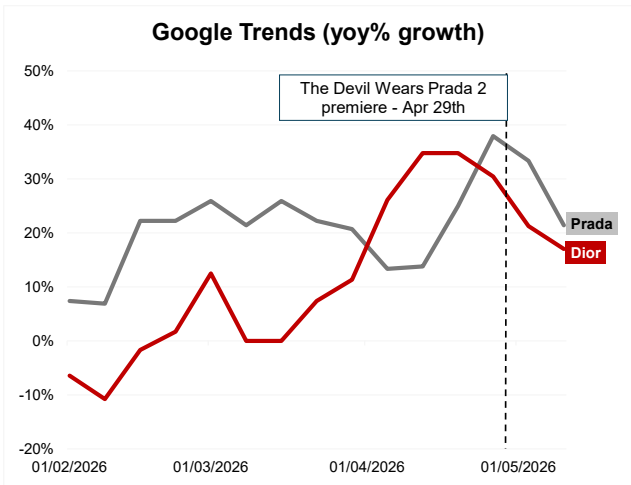
Bloomingdale's 59th St x Wuthering Heights - January 15th - February 22nd

The Bloomingdale's x Wuthering Heights installation captured the mood of the movie through striking visuals and evocative story-telling. This aesthetic, as well as the products advertised were shoppable in the pop up dedicated to the film on the ground floor of the department store. This curated *Carouse! Shop* offered exclusive merchandise tied to the film's themes and fashion, creating a full sensory engagement through sight, story and shopping. Highlights included a 35-piece exclusive AQUA x Wuthering Heights capsule collection, licensed products and lifestyle goods that fit into the narrative - like silk pillowcases and floral teas.

Source: Company website, Bernstein analysis

The open question is whether brands can consistently turn these cultural spikes into sustainable revenue before the moment evaporates. PVH's CEO gave concrete examples of how Calvin Klein is trying to do just that: a 90s-heavy product assortment and marketing focus, which generated higher-than-average social engagement and click-through rates, and strategic styling of key talent. By contrast, Prada and Dior appear to have kept a more measured distance from the launch of [The Devil Wears Prada 2](#). Despite a short-lived uptick in Google searches and dressing key talent for red carpets, they have not leaned fully into the phenomenon. That hasn't deterred others: we count more than ten brands, from Grey Goose to United Airlines, that have jumped in with opportunistic campaigns. The underlying lesson is clear: brands can no longer rely on heritage or product alone. They need to exist inside a wider cultural ecosystem—where image, narrative and accessibility reinforce one another—or risk watching others harvest the trends that their own products helped inspire in the first place.

EXHIBIT 16: **Prada and Dior appear to have kept a more measured distance from the launch of The Devil Wears Prada 2, despite a short-lived uptick in Google searches given their organic link to the film.**



Source: Googl Trends, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 17: **Both Prada and Dior dressed key talent for the red carpet, but this failed to attract a similar frenzy to Margot Robbie’s press tours.**



Source: Instagram, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 18: **Even if Prada and Dior have not leaned into the phenomenon, we count more than ten brands, from Grey Goose to United Airlines, that have jumped in with opportunistic campaigns.**

The Devil Wears Prada 2	
Brand	Movie-inspired activation/collaboration
Diet Coke / Smartwater	Diet Coke red heels ad and a limited edition 'Canny Pack'
Gray Goose	Cerulean Blue campaign poster, five cocktails inspired by the movie
Mercedes-Maybach	The Art of Arrival campaign
Starbucks	Social media campaign
United Airlines	United replaced its little blue digital plane with red heels on its flight trackers.
Vogue Magazine	May cover Anna Wintour and Meryl Streep
RE/DONE x Disney	T-shirt capsule collection
Lulus	14 piece capsule collection of gowns
Walmart	limited edition capsule collection priced \$16 - \$54
Tweezerman	Limited edition five-piece toolkit
L’Oréal Paris	Advert with Simone Ashley and Kendall Jenner
TRESemmé	Special-edition product bundle

Source: Company websites, WWD, Bernstein analysis

DISCLOSURE APPENDIX

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Coverage Suspended: Coverage of a company under the Bernstein research brand has been suspended. Ratings and price targets are suspended temporarily, are no longer current, and should therefore not be relied upon.

Not Rated: A rating assigned when the stock cannot be accurately valued, or the performance of the company accurately predicted, at the present time. The covering analyst may continue to publish research reports on the company to update investors on events and developments.

Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

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The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 500 Banks And Financial Services Index (BEBANKS) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 500 Insurance Index (BEINSUR) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, and the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

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- Neutral (N): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to perform in line with preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Underperform (UP): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to underperform preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

Autonomous preferred stock ratings are based on a 6-month time horizon.

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- Credit Outperform (C-OP): The total return of the Reference Credit Instrument is expected to outperform the credit spread of bonds of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

- **Credit Neutral (C-N):** The total return of the Reference Credit Instrument is expected to perform in line with the credit spread of bonds of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- **Credit Underperform (C-UP):** The total return of the Reference Credit Instrument is expected to underperform the credit spread of bonds of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

Autonomous credit ratings are based on a 6-month time horizon.

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Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	36.3%	17.8%
Underperform	SELL	12.6%	14.9%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.

As of March 31, 2026. All figures are updated quarterly.

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